JOURNALISTS IN THE CROSSHAIRS

At the time Snowden leaked NSA documents, no journalist had ever been prosecuted in the United States for publishing classified information. But in 2013, the FBI described Fox News Washington Bureau Chief James Rosen as a co-conspirator in a leaks case and acquired his e-mails. Government officials, such as New York congressman Peter King and former NSA director Michael Hayden, said reporters working on Snowden's NSA stories should be prosecuted. As of September 2015, Greenwald and Poitras were not facing any criminal charges for aiding Snowden and releasing NSA documents to the press.

50,000 documents—were in the hands of news organizations. Those organizations included the *Intercept*, the publishing company started by Laura Poitras and Glenn Greenwald, and newspapers including the *Guardian*, the *New York Times*, *Der Spiegel*, and the *Washington Post*. As of September 2015, approximately 400 of the documents had been published.[3] Alan Rusbridger, the *Guardian's* editor-in-chief, said to the Home Affairs Select Committee about publishing the documents, "We've been working slowly and responsibly. . . . We're not going to be put off by intimidation, but nor are we going to behave recklessly."[4]

Poitras and Greenwald were unsure whether they would ever share all of the documents Snowden gave them:

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